105. Which one of the following was the venue for the preliminary talks between the Sri Lankan Government and representative of Tamil United Liberation Front and other militant groups?

(a) New Delhi (b) Colombo
(c) Thimpu (d) Madras

Ans. (c) : The preliminary talks between the Sri Lankan government liberation front and other militant group was held at Thimpu, the capital of Bhutan.

106. 'MERCOSUR' consists of group of countries of:

(a) Africa (b) Asia
(c) Latin America (d) South East Asia

Ans. (c) : Mercosur is an economic and political block comprising Argentina, Brazil, Paraguay, Uruguay, and Venezuela.

107. Indonesian forest fire in 1997 was caused by:

(a) Greenhouse effect
(b) Depletion of ozone layer
(c) El Nino effect
(d) None of the above

Ans. (d) : It's a game of blame, with everyone pointing their finger at someone else. WWF Indonesia environmental group, which has been highlighting the problem of the recurring fires in Indonesia for years, says that the fires are caused by the collective negligence of businesses,
Smallholders and government (which does not invest adequately in preventive measures). Many blame big business. According to a recent report, big business is responsible.

108. Bharat Ratna was awarded 1997 to:

(a) Dr. Homi Bhabha (Posthumous)
(b) Former Presidnet R. Venkataraman
(c) Satyajit Ray (Posthumous)
(d) Dr. Abdul Kalam

Ans. (d) : Abdul Kalam was the recipient of Bharat Ratna 1997.

109. Which of the following statements are true about the Indian-born woman astronaut Kalpana Chawla?

1. She was born in Karnal.
2. She flew on board the shuttle flight STS-87
3. She was trained at the Kennedy Space Centre.
4. She did a space-walk to retrieve the Spartan Satellite.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

Codes:

(a) 1 and 2 (b) 2 and 3
(c) 1, 2 and 3 (d) 1, 2 and 4

Ans. (c) : During STS-87, she was responsible for deploying the Spartan satellite which malfunctioned, necessitating a spacewalk by Winston Scott and Takao Doi to capture the satellite. Other statements are correct.

110. According to Meadows (1972), if the present trends in world population, indusrialization, population, food production and resource depletion continue unchanged, the "Limits to Growth" on our planet will he reached in the next:

(a) 50 years (b) 100 years
(c) 150 years (d) 200 years

Ans. (b) : In 1972 the book "Limits to Growth" was published Its authors were Donella H. Meadows, Dennis L. Meadows, Jorgen Randers. Its sent out shock waves around the world. It contained a warning that by the year 2100 the world might be on a collision course with catastrophe if then current rates of growth in such areas as resource use industrial output food production and population expansion continued on their then current course This warning was the result of computer modeling of a variety of future scenarios, based on different assumptions concerning the future state of the world applied to the best data available regarding various growth parameters.

111. Human Poverty Index was introduced in the Human Development Report of the year:

(a) 1994 (b) 1995
(c) 1996 (d) 1997

Ans. (d) : The Human Poverty Index (HPI) was an indication of the standard of living in a country, developed by the United Nations (UN) to complement the Human Development Index (HDI) and was first reported as part of the Human Development Report in 1997. It was considered to better reflect the extent of deprivation in developed countries compared to the HDI. In 2010 it was supplanted by the UN's Multidimensional Poverty Index. The HPI concentrates on the deprivation in the three essential elements of human life already reflected in the HDI: longevity, knowledge and a decent standard of living.

112. The recent Land Mines Conference to sign the historic treaty was held in the Capital city of:

(a) Canada (b) Japan
(c) Sweden (d) Zimbabwe

Ans. (a) : The historic treaty on land mines was signed on 3rd to 5th December at the conference held in Ottawa, the capital of Canada. The Ottawa treaty banned landmines.

113. Which of the following pairs are correctly matched?

1. Dow Jones : New York
2. Hang Seng : Seoul
3. FTSE-100 : London

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

Codes:

(a) 1, 2 and 3 (b) 2 and 3
(c) 1 and 2 (d) 1 and 3

Ans. (d) : Hang Seng is the stock market of Hong Kong not Seoul. Rest 1 and 3 are correctly matched.

114. The Economist who was associated with the W.T.O. draft document is:

(a) A. K. Sen (b) T. N. Srinivasan
(c) J. N. Bhagwati (d) Avinash Dixit

Ans. (c) : J.N. Bhagwati is the Economist who is associated with the drafting of W.T.O. He is an American economist who has an immense role to play in the reshaping of the world economy.

115. The number of economically active women (excluding students and those doing domestic duties in their homes) as a percentage of all women of working age (generally those aged 15-64 years) was the highest in 1996 in:

(a) U.S.A. (b) China
(c) Russia (d) S. Korea

Ans. (b) : In 1996 it was 43% in China. Hence when the question was asked the correct answer was (b) China.

MISCELLANEOUS

116. What are the official languages of the U.N.O.?

(a) English, French and Russian
(b) English, French, German and Russian
(c) English, French, Russian, Chinese and Hindi
(d) English, French, Chinese, Russian, Arabic and Spanish

Ans. (d) : English, French, Chinese, Russian, Arabic and Spanish are the official language of U.N.O.

117. Which of the following parties were not a part of the United Front which was in power during '96-97'?

1. Bahujana Samaj Party
2. Samata Party
3. Haryana Vikas Party
4. Asam Gana Parishad

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

Codes:

(a) 1, 2, 3 and 4 (b) 1, 2 and 3
(c) 3 and 4 (d) 1 and 2

Ans. (b) : Bahujan Samaj Party, Haryana Vikas party and Samta Party were not the part of the United Font.

Directions:

The following fourteen items consists of two statements, one labelled as 'Assertion A' and the other labelled as 'Reason R'. Your are to examine these two statements carefully and decide if the Assertion A and the Reasons R are individually true and if so, whether the Reason is a correct explanation of the Assertion. Select your answers to these items using the codes given below and mark your answer sheet accordingly.

Codes:

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
(b) Both A and R are true but R is NOT a correct explanation of A
(c) A is true but R is false
(d) A is false but R is true

118. Assertion (A) : The Gandhara School of Art bears the mark of Hellenistic influence.
Reason (R) : Hinayana form was influenced by that art.

Ans. (c) : Gandhara School of Art was highly influenced by Greeks. But, it was Mahayana form of Buddhism that was influenced by that art.

119. Assertion (A) : Formic acid is a stronger acid than Acetic acid.
Reason (R) : Formic acid is an organic acid.

Ans. (b) : Formic acid is stronger than acetic acid due to its chemical composition. Formic acid is an organic acid as well as Acetic acid also an organic acid.

120. Assertion (A) : At first the Turkish administration in India was essentially military.
Reason (R) : The country was parcelled out as 'Iqtas' among leading military leaders.

Ans. (a) : Turkish administration in India was essentially military when the conquered the country, they divided it into a number of tracts called Iqtas which were paracelled out among the leading Turkish nobles. Hence both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is correct. explanation of (A).

121. Assertion (A) : According to Ashoka's edicts social harmony among the people was more important than religious devotion.
Reason (R) : He spread ideas of equity instead of promotion of religion.

Ans. (a) : By spreading ideas of equity instead of promoting religion, Ashoka's edicts stress social harmony among people.